

Eight Easy-to-Use Open Source Hybrid Mobile Application Development Platforms

Mobile applications are either pre-installed on phones by the manufacturer, or delivered as Web applications using server-side or client-side processing to provide an application-like experience within a Web browser. Developing apps for different platforms, however, is a challenge, which can be addressed by using some of the best mobile application development frameworks discussed in this article.



For a large number of people, developing a high-end mobile application is a cumbersome task that requires a lot of programming skills and effort. Today, it is more important that the app you develop runs on all popular mobile operating systems. Hybrid mobile app developers are now able to write code once and build mobile applications that run on the main platforms with no extra effort. The same code for the mobile application that runs on Android and iOS can be reused for progressive Web applications and even desktop applications.

A framework is regarded as a complex software development environment. It includes many sub-components that help developers to create their respective apps. Sub-components may include tool sets, compilers, debuggers, application programming interfaces, different code libraries and many other components. A framework creates a strong base for mobile applications. Its professional usage simplifies the entire app development life cycle. Developers these days prefer to use frameworks to write apps instead of writing an application from scratch and dealing with thousands of lines of code to make the app multi-platform compliant.

In order to develop a mobile app that runs on multiple mobile operating system platforms, choosing the desired framework can be a complex task. Here is a list of some of the best open source mobile application development frameworks which are highly effective, helping developers to write apps in an easy manner.

1. Framework 7

Framework 7 is regarded as a full-featured mobile app development framework for iOS. It is a free and open source mobile HTML framework for developing mobile apps. Now it also offers Android app development support and has become an indispensable prototyping apps tool that builds a working app prototype very quickly.

Framework 7 gives app developers the opportunity to create iOS and Android apps with HTML, CSS and JavaScript in an easy and concise manner. It is not compatible with all platforms; rather, it mainly focuses on iOS and Google Material Design to offer the best-in-industry experience.

Features

- *Easy to use:* Framework 7 is easy to understand. It requires just basic knowledge of HTML, CSS and JS. It doesn't require developers to write custom tasks that will be converted by JavaScript to something else. You can write the entire app in simple HTML, and expect to get what you write.
- *iOs-Specific:* Framework 7 is iOS-specific. It provides an incredible platform for developers to realise all its features, which range from UI elements visualisation to complex animation and touchscreen interactions.
- *UI components:* Framework 7 is bundled with ready-to-use UI elements and widgets like modals, pop-ups, action sheets, pop-overs, list views, media lists, tabs, side panels, layout grids, pre-loaders, form elements, etc.